

₹1,400

crore

WEWORK INDIA REVENUE IN FY23, UP 75 PER CENT FROM FY22

6.5

million sq. ft

THE OFFICE SPACE WEWORK INDIA HAS ACROSS 7 CITIES



es and leasing rates in the US.

Even so, the global entity's decision to file for bankruptcy couldn't have come at a worse time for WeWork India. The Bengaluru-based company has been growing handsomely post-Covid-19 and even turned profitable.

According to Virwani, WeWork India's revenue jumped from ₹800 crore in FY22 to ₹1,400 crore in FY23, while its Ebitda (earnings before interest, tax, depreciation, and amortisation) stood at ₹250 crore in FY23. And it sees that momentum increasing in FY24, with Virwani expecting to end the year with 40-50 per cent year-on-year growth in its revenue. "I expect this trend to continue for the next two years," he tells *BT*. WeWork India has over 90,000 desks and 6.5 million sq. ft of space, spread across 50 locations in seven cities. Virwani says the firm is well positioned to add 20,000 desks every year.

WeWork Global has a 27 per cent stake acquired for \$100 million at the height of the Covid-19 pandemic, when the Indian arm needed cash. Though WeWork India has refused to reveal what it intends to do, sources say the Embassy Group is looking to buy back the stake. Experts say this could be the ideal time, as it may get the stake at a cheaper valuation.

Virwani, meanwhile, is unfazed. "Any development globally has no bearing on the operations of the business. In India, we will continue to operate and serve our members, landlords, and partners as usual," he says. "We are backed by the Embassy Group. We have achieved consistent and sustainable growth, operationally and financially."

In fact, Virwani is moving ahead with plans to expand. "We always have a situation where demand is ahead of supply. Our goal is to have 15 million sq. ft capacity—up from 6.5 million sq. ft now. I believe there is enough room for us to grow," he says. **BT**

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